

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The matrimonial and family legal assistant role at Davies and Partners interests me because it sits at the intersection of procedural legal work and direct client support, both of which form the core of what I do at Citizens Advice East Berkshire. My background in advising clients on sensitive legal matters, managing case files and drafting correspondence across family, housing and employment matters maps closely onto the day-to-day demands of this position.

At Citizens Advice I work with clients on welfare benefits, housing, employment, family and debt matters, taking detailed factual statements, identifying evidential gaps and managing cases through to submission. Because many of my clients are in difficult personal circumstances, I have had to develop a way of handling sensitive conversations that keeps people informed without overwhelming them. I draft correspondence, prepare document schedules and maintain confidential case records, so the file and deadline management this role requires is work I do regularly.

At BCLP, where I completed a year-long placement, I supported a complex investment arbitration over six months and a busy real estate disputes team for the other six. The arbitration rotation gave me direct experience of tracking procedural deadlines, coordinating documents across a team and helping to prepare submissions to a significant deadline. At one point I became the only junior on the matter shortly before that deadline, which required me to organise outstanding actions and communicate clearly with the team to ensure everything was filed on time. In real estate disputes I prepared hearing bundles, managed large volumes of documents across matters with competing deadlines and maintained matter records using iManage. Both rotations developed the organised, deadline-conscious approach to casework that a busy family practice needs.

Davies and Partners' reputation across both individual and business client work, and the genuinely varied caseload this role describes, appeals to me because it matches the range I already handle at Citizens Advice, where no two matters are the same. Family law in particular requires careful client communication and procedural accuracy, and my experience at Citizens Advice and BCLP has developed both.

I am based in the Maidenhead area and regularly travel to London, making the Charing Cross office straightforward to reach.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva